SME SOUTH AFRICA

Personalised Business Feed

User Guide

Version 1.0.0 | April 2026
Business made easier.

Welcome

SME South Africa is built for South African entrepreneurs. With over 100,000 monthly readers on our platform, we noticed one problem: everyone sees the same generic content. This app fixes that.

It learns from what you care about — the topics you select, search for, read and save — and brings the most relevant funding, marketing, tax, technology and compliance content to the top of your feed. The more you use it, the smarter it gets.

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1. Getting Started

Requirements: Android 7.0 or newer, internet connection, 50MB free space.

Installation:
• From Play Store: Search 'SME South Africa' and tap Install.

• From APK: Download the APK, allow installation from unknown sources if prompted, and open.
• First launch: The app prepares your content library. This takes a few seconds and only happens once.

2. Creating Your Account

Your account keeps your personalised feed, saved articles and preferences in sync across devices.

To create an account:
1. Tap 'Create Account'
2. Enter your full name
3. Enter your email address
4. Create a password (minimum 6 characters)
5. Confirm your password
6. Tap Create Account

To sign in:
Enter your email and password and tap Login. Your feed will restore automatically.

Passwords are encrypted and securely stored. We never share your details.

3. Personalising Your Feed

This is the most important step. Your selections teach the app what matters to your business.

You will see 9 business categories:
■ Funding • ■ Marketing • ■ Tax • ■ Technology • ■ Compliance • ■■ Operations • ■ Finance • ■ Business Growth • ■ Starting a Business

Tap any category to select it. Selected cards turn green. You can choose as many as you like. We recommend 2-4 to start.

Tap 'Continue to Personalised Feed'. Your home feed will now prioritise content from those categories.

You can change this anytime in Profile > Edit Interests.

4. Your Home Feed

Your Home feed is the heart of the app.

At the top:
• A greeting personalised to you
• Your current interests summary
• Search bar — tap to explore topics

Recommended for You:
Articles are ordered by relevance to you. Each card shows:
• Category and icon

• Relevance Score — higher means more relevant to your behaviour
• Title and short description
• Reading time and author

Tap any card to read the full article.

Trending: Below your recommendations, see what other entrepreneurs are reading right now.

5. Reading Articles

Every article is written for South African SMEs with practical, actionable advice.

Inside an article:
• Category, title, author and reading time
• Full content with local context (e.g., SEFA, CIPC, SARS)
• Feedback: Tap 'Yes, useful' if you found it helpful. This improves your future recommendations.
• Save: Tap 'Save Article' to add it to your personal library. It turns to 'Saved'.
• Share: Share the article via WhatsApp, email or any app.
• Related: See 3 more articles from the same category.

Reading an article for more than a minute tells us you found it valuable, so we show you more like it.

6. Exploring Topics

Tap 'Explore' in the bottom navigation or tap the search bar on Home.

Search: Type anything, e.g. 'funding' or 'tax'. Results filter instantly.
Search & Learn: Tap 'Search' to save your search. This trains your feed to show more of what you searched for.
Categories: Quick filter chips — tap Funding to see only funding articles.
Recent searches: Your last 3 searches appear here for quick access.

7. Your Saved Library

Tap 'Saved' in the bottom navigation.

This is your personal library. All articles you saved appear here with a green bookmark.

If you have not saved anything yet, you will see a friendly empty state explaining how to save.
Tap any saved article to read it again.

8. Managing Your Profile

Tap 'Profile' in the bottom navigation.

Your profile card shows your name, email and role.
My Interests shows your current selected categories and their priority weight.
Edit Interests: Change your topics anytime.

Settings:
• Notifications — get alerted about new content in your interests
• Newsletter — weekly roundup of top articles

How recommendations work: A clear explanation of the scoring system is shown in your profile so you always know why you see what you see.

Logout: Securely signs you out.

9. How Your Feed Learns

Your feed uses a simple, transparent scoring system. No black box.

Every article gets a relevance score based on your behaviour:

• Interest Match +5 — you selected this category
• Search Match +4 — you searched for this topic
• Reading History +3 per read — you have read similar articles before
• Deep Read +4 — you spent over 60 seconds reading
• Same Category +2 — you have engaged with this category before
• Saved +5 — you saved this article
• Liked +5 — you marked it as useful

Example: You select Funding (+5), search 'funding' (+4), read a Funding article for 85 seconds (+3 +4). That Funding article now has a score of 16 and moves to the top of your feed.

The more you interact, the more accurate your feed becomes.

10. Help & Support

Common Questions:

My feed isn't changing?
Try tapping the refresh icon at the top of Home after reading or searching. Make sure you have an internet connection.

Why am I seeing a Score of 0?
Score 0 means we haven't learned your preference for that topic yet. Read, search and save more articles to train your feed.

How do I change my interests?
Go to Profile > Edit Interests, select new categories and tap Continue.

Where is my data stored?
Your data is securely stored in South Africa (africa-south1 region) using enterprise-grade encryption. We collect only what you choose to share — your selected interests, searches, reading activity and saved articles.

Does it work offline?
You can read previously loaded articles offline. For personalised recommendations and new content, you need internet.

Need more help?
In the app, go to Profile > Help & Support for FAQs and contact details.
Email: support@smesouthafrica.co.za
Website: www.smesouthafrica.co.za

SME South Africa — Business made easier.